

Australia is one of many countries that exports livestock by sea and air all over the world.

Our definition of livestock includes sheep, goats, cattle, deer, buffalo and camelids.

The livestock export industry provides over \$1.6 billion to our economy. Many rural and regional communities rely on the trade to provide valuable income and employment to their region.

Our role

As the regulator, we enforce high standards. These standards reflect the values of our livestock export industry and the Australian community. This includes regulating against our strict Australian legislative and animal welfare requirements. We ensure consignments exported meet importing country requirements.

Every 6 months we [report to Parliament](#) under [our regulatory framework](#). The reports include data on livestock mortalities for every sea voyage.

We are committed to maintaining a strong and efficient regulatory framework. Read more about our [live animal export reforms](#).

Animal health and welfare

Australia leads the world in animal welfare. We are an active member of the [World Organisation for Animal Health \(WOAH\)](#).

We have a unique regulatory system, unlike any other country that exports livestock. We require exporters of livestock for human consumption (known as feeder and slaughter livestock) to have arrangements in place with supply chain partners. This ensures humane treatment and handling of livestock is provided from the time they arrive in the importing country up to and including the point of slaughter.

Your role

Quick-find reference tables

Use these tables to locate departmental webpages, documents and information relevant to livestock exports.

Learn more about non-livestock exports (such as dogs, cats, horses, zoo animals and reproductive material) at [exporting live animals](#).

Regulation and compliance

Subject name	Type	Relevant webpage...
	Statement	Compliance investigations

Compliance statement for the export of livestock

ESCAS – complaints and investigations	Reports	ESCAS investigations
ESCAS – regulatory performance reports	Reports	ESCAS investigations
Independent observers – summary reports	Reports	Independent observer summary reports
Notifiable mortality incidents – compliance investigations	Reports	Investigations into notifiable mortality incidents
Publication of regulatory decisions	Public statements	Published regulatory decisions
Regulating live animal exports – includes links to relevant legislation	Information	Regulating live animal exports
Regulatory activity reporting – annual summary	Information	Regulatory activity reporting for live animal exports
Reports to Parliament – livestock mortalities by sea	Reports	Reports to Parliament

Stakeholder communication and engagement

Subject name	Type	Relevant webpage...
Contact us – live animal exports	Contacts	Live animal export office contacts
DAFF – have your say	Consultation platform	Have your say
Export advisory notices (EAN) – includes link to DAFF subscription centre	Notices	Live animal export advisory notices
Inspector-General of animal welfare and live animal exports (IGAWLAE)	Reviews	IGAWLAE
Market access notices (MAN) – includes link to DAFF subscription centre	Notices	Market access notices
Phase out of live sheep exports by sea	Information	Phase out of live sheep exports by sea
Public comment – includes our communication limitations during livestock incidents	Information	Public comment on livestock exports
Reforming live animal exports	Information	Reforming live animal exports
Stakeholder communication and engagement policy	Policy	Exporting live animals
Whistleblower hotline – to report information confidentially	Information	Whistleblower hotline

Statistics, fees and charges

Subject name	Type	Relevant webpage...
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Fees and charges – DAFF	Information	Fees and charges
Live animal exports – cost recovery implementation statements (CRIS)	Information	Agricultural exports CRIS
Price fact sheet for all export arrangements (see Appendix E for live animal exports)	Fact sheet	Agricultural exports CRIS
Statistics – live animal exports	Statistics	Live animal export statistics

Systems, forms and standards

Subject name	Type	Relevant webpage...
Application forms – livestock	Forms	Forms for exporting livestock
Australian standards for the export of livestock (ASEL)	Information	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Manual of importing country requirements (Micor) – live animals	Reference	Micor – live animals (login required)
Tracking animal certification for export (TRACE)	System	Tracking animal certification for export – TRACE

Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
AAV contact list	Reference	Current accredited veterinarians
Guideline for the identification and management of material interests for AAVs	Guidelines	Become an accredited veterinarian
Roles and responsibilities of AAVs	Guidelines	Accredited veterinarians

Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
Alternative minimum pen space allocation policy	Policy	Approved arrangements
AA guidelines for the export of livestock	Guidelines	Approved arrangements
AEP guidelines for the export of livestock	Guidelines	Approved export program
Core documents for approved arrangement livestock exports	Reference	Exporting a livestock consignment
Performance management and compliance guidelines	Guidelines	Approved arrangements
Performance management and compliance guidelines – fact sheet	Fact sheet	Approved arrangements

Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
ASEL air crate space allocation calculator	Calculator	Australian standards for the export of livestock
	Guidebook	

ASEL rejection criteria guidebook – cattle and buffalo		Australian standards for the export of livestock
ASEL rejection criteria guidebook – sheep and goats	Guidebook	Australian standards for the export of livestock
ASEL version 3.3	Standards	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
Exemptions for livestock, live animals and animal reproductive material	Policy	Exemptions
Operations and governance manual guidelines	Guidelines	Exemptions
Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
ESCAO approved arrangements – application form	Form	Exporter supply chain assurance system
ESCAO approved arrangements – application checklist	Checklist	Exporter supply chain assurance system
ESCAO approved arrangements guidelines	Guidelines	Exporter supply chain assurance system
Third-party provider of assurance services (TPPAS) – periodic reporting requirements	Requirements	Exporter supply chain assurance system
Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
ESCAS accounting and traceability declaration (cattle and buffalo)	Template	Apply, vary and maintain your ESCAS
ESCAS animal welfare standards	Standards	Exporter supply chain assurance system
ESCAS control and traceability declaration	Template	Apply, vary and maintain your ESCAS
ESCAS management of non-compliance guidelines	Guidelines	Compliance investigations
Document name	Document type	Document can be found at...
AAVs and stockpersons on sea voyages – applying for alternative arrangements	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Breeder cattle by sea – applying for validity extension for pregnancy testing	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Calculating onboard feed and water provisions under ASEL	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock
	Policy	Livestock export licence

Conditions on livestock export licences – suspicions and detections of exotic animal diseases		
Contingency plans for livestock consignments to the Middle East	Policy	Exporting a livestock consignment
Independent observer deployment policy	Policy	Independent observers Exporting a livestock consignment
Livestock identification requirements in laboratory test reports	Policy	(see table in ‘pre-export documentation requirements’)
Loading foreign sourced fodder onto a vessel carrying Australian livestock	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Penning of immature bulls and steers under ASEL	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock Exporting a livestock consignment
Property of origin for livestock exports	Policy	(see table in ‘pre-export documentation requirements’)
Stock on hand in registered establishments for livestock exports	Policy	Exporting a livestock consignment Exporting a livestock consignment
Timing of health status documentation for livestock exports	Policy	(see table in ‘pre-export documentation requirements’)
Voyage length calculations under ASEL	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Voyage reporting requirements under ASEL	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock
Water deprivation time for livestock exported by air under ASEL	Policy	Australian standards for the export of livestock

Stay informed

Subscribe to [Export Advisory Notices \(EANs\)](#) and [Market Access Notices \(MANs\)](#). EANs will notify you of any changes to requirements. MANs will notify you of any market specific changes.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/controlled-goods/live-animals/livestock>